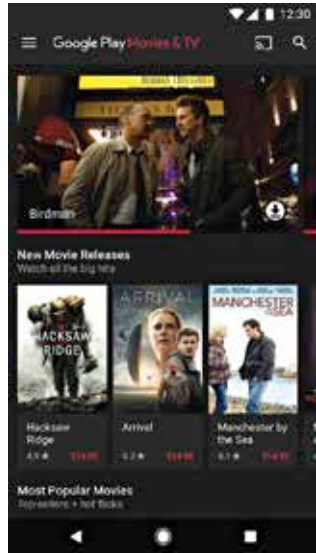


already turning 5 by then. But to Play Movies' credit, it has soldiered on, in the face of rather formidable competition. It's one of the most available video streaming services ever, spanning about 110 countries and like Play Books, it can be accessed through either a browser or the dedicated app. Most smart TVs also support Play Movies so that you can stream directly to your TV. Play Movies has also been praised for having a good selection of local content compared to the other providers but the good things stop there. There is nothing inherently bad about it, but it's just that the competition just does things better.



Tastefully done, but we still prefer Netflix... sorry.

Play Newsstand

Anyone remember Google Currents? For those who don't, Currents was a social magazine article aggregator which collected articles from over 150 sources based on interests you set and presented in a tidy and organized manner. In 2013, Play Magazines, Google's erstwhile digital magazine distribution platform and Currents merged together to form Google Play Newsstand. It's a digital newspaper and magazine distributor that allows you to read, buy and subscribe to different publications. As it's common with all the other multimedia Play apps, you can access your subscriptions through a browser or the dedicated app. Google Play Newsstand is available worldwide, with regional content catered to your country. The paid parts of Newsstand are currently available in about 35 countries.

All the apps featured next don't exactly come under the Google Play moniker but they are apps all from Google that share quite a few of the same philosophies as the Play apps. They are very rarely pre-installed on phones, meaning you have to actively search for them to download them but are all offerings that are worth a mention.

Calendar

Google Calendar is one of those things that once you start using, you can't believe you ever lived without. It's a digital calendar (surprise surprise!)